Text 1

第 1 段

How can the train operators possibly justify yet another increase to rail passenger fares? It has become a grimly reliable annual ritual: every January the cost of travelling by train rises, imposing a significant extra burden on those who have no option but to use the rail network to get to work or otherwise. This year's rise, an average of 2.7 per cent, may be a fraction lower than last year's, but it is still well above the official Consumer Price Index (CPI) measure of inflation.

直译：铁路运营商究竟怎样才能为又一次提高客运票价辩护？这已经成为一种令人沮丧、却年年如期上演的惯例：每到一月，乘火车的费用就上涨，给那些除了利用铁路通勤或出行之外别无选择的人，增加一笔可观的负担。今年平均百分之二点七的涨幅，可能比去年略低，但仍远高于以官方消费者价格指数（CPI）衡量的通货膨胀率。

第 2 段

Successive governments have permitted such increases on the grounds that the cost of investing in and running the rail network should be borne by those who use it, rather than the general taxpayer. Why, the argument goes, should a car-driving pensioner from Lincolnshire have to subsidise the daily commute of a stockbroker from Surrey? Equally, there is a sense that the travails of commuters in the South East, many of whom will face among the biggest rises, have received too much attention compared to those who must endure the relatively poor infrastructure of the Midlands and the North.

直译：历届政府都允许这样的涨价，理由是投资和运营铁路网的成本，应由使用铁路的人承担，而不是由一般纳税人承担。这种论点说，为什么林肯郡一个开车的退休者，要补贴萨里郡一个股票经纪人的每日通勤呢？同样，也有人认为，与那些必须忍受英格兰中部和北部相对落后基础设施的人相比，东南部通勤者的艰辛受到了过多关注，而后者中的许多人又将面临最大幅度的票价上涨。

第 3 段

However, over the past 12 months, those commuters have also experienced some of the worst rail strikes in years. It is all very well train operators trumpeting the improvements they are making to the network, but passengers should be able to expect a basic level of service for the substantial sums they are now paying to travel. The responsibility for the latest wave of strikes rests on the unions. However, there is a strong case that those who have been worst affected by industrial action should receive compensation for the disruption they have suffered.

直译：然而，在过去十二个月里，这些通勤者也经历了近年来最严重的一些铁路罢工。铁路运营商大肆宣扬自己对铁路网作出的改善，这固然可以，但乘客如今为出行支付了可观的金额，理应能够期待基本水平的服务。最近一轮罢工的责任在工会。然而，有充分理由认为，那些受到劳工行动影响最严重的人，应该因其所遭受的出行中断而获得补偿。

第 4 段

The Government has pledged to change the law to introduce a minimum service requirement so that, even when strikes occur, services can continue to operate. This should form part of a wider package of measures to address the long-running problems on Britain's railways. Yes, more investment is needed, but passengers will not be willing to pay more indefinitely if they must also endure cramped, unreliable services, punctuated by regular chaos when timetables are changed, or planned maintenance is managed incompetently. The threat of nationalisation may have been seen off for now, but it will return with a vengeance if the justified anger of passengers is not addressed in short order.

直译：政府已承诺修改法律，引入最低服务要求，以便即使发生罢工，服务仍能继续运行。这应当成为解决英国铁路长期问题的一整套更广泛措施中的一部分。是的，需要更多投资，但如果乘客同时还必须忍受拥挤、不可靠的服务，以及更改时刻表或无能地安排计划检修时反复出现的混乱，他们就不会愿意无限期地支付更高票价。国有化的威胁目前或许已经被挡住，但如果乘客有正当理由的愤怒不能迅速得到回应，它就会以更猛烈的势头卷土重来。

Text 2

第 1 段

Last year marked the third year in a row when Indonesia's bleak rate of deforestation has slowed in pace. One reason for the turnaround may be the country's antipoverty program.

直译：去年，印度尼西亚令人担忧的森林砍伐速度连续第三年有所放缓。这一转变的原因之一，可能是该国的扶贫计划。

第 2 段

In 2007, Indonesia started phasing in a program that gives money to its poorest residents under certain conditions, such as requiring people to keep kids in school or get regular medical care. Called conditional cash transfers or CCTs, these social assistance programs are designed to reduce inequality and break the cycle of poverty. They're already used in dozens of countries worldwide. In Indonesia, the program has provided enough food and medicine to substantially reduce severe growth problems among children.

直译：二○○七年，印度尼西亚开始逐步推行一项计划，在某些条件下向最贫困的居民发放现金，例如要求他们让孩子继续上学，或接受定期医疗服务。这些被称为“有条件现金转移支付”（CCT）的社会援助项目，旨在减少不平等、打破贫困循环。它们已经在全球数十个国家使用。在印度尼西亚，该计划提供了足够的食物和药品，使儿童严重的生长发育问题大幅减少。

第 3 段

But CCT programs don't generally consider effects on the environment. In fact, poverty alleviation and environmental protection are often viewed as conflicting goals, says Paul Ferraro, an economist at Johns Hopkins University.

直译：但 CCT 项目通常不考虑对环境的影响。约翰斯·霍普金斯大学经济学家保罗·费拉罗说，实际上，减贫与环境保护常被看作相互冲突的目标。

第 4 段

That's because economic growth can be correlated with environmental degradation, while protecting the environment is sometimes correlated with greater poverty. However, those correlations don't prove cause and effect. The only previous study analyzing causality, based on an area in Mexico that had instituted CCTs, supported the traditional view. There, as people got more money, some of them may have cleared more land for cattle to raise for meat, Ferraro says.

直译：这是因为，经济增长可能与环境退化相关，而保护环境有时又与更加严重的贫困相关。然而，这些相关关系并不能证明因果关系。此前唯一一项分析因果关系的研究，基于墨西哥一个实施了 CCT 的地区，支持了传统观点。费拉罗说，在那里，随着人们获得更多钱，其中一些人可能开垦了更多土地，用来饲养供肉用的牛。

第 5 段

Such programs do not have to negatively affect the environment, though. Ferraro wanted to see if Indonesia's poverty-alleviation program was affecting deforestation. Indonesia has the third-largest area of tropical forest in the world and one of the highest deforestation rates.

直译：不过，这类项目并不必然对环境产生负面影响。费拉罗想知道，印度尼西亚的减贫计划是否正在影响森林砍伐。印度尼西亚拥有世界第三大的热带森林面积，同时也是森林砍伐率最高的国家之一。

第 6 段

Ferraro analyzed satellite data showing annual forest loss from 2008 to 2012—including during Indonesia's phase-in of the antipoverty program—in 7,468 forested villages across 15 provinces. "We see that the program is associated with a 30 percent reduction in deforestation," Ferraro says.

直译：费拉罗分析了卫星数据，数据展示了二〇〇八年至二〇一二年间，十五个省份七千四百六十八个有森林覆盖的村庄每年的森林损失情况，其中包括印度尼西亚逐步实施扶贫计划的时期。费拉罗说："我们看到，这项计划与森林砍伐减少百分之三十相关联。"

第 7 段

That's likely because the rural poor are using the money as makeshift insurance policies against inclement weather, Ferraro says. Typically, if rains are delayed, people may clear land to plant more rice to supplement their harvests.

直译：费拉罗说，这很可能是因为，农村贫困人口把这笔钱当作应对恶劣天气的临时保险。通常，如果降雨推迟，人们可能会清理土地，种植更多稻米，以补充收成。

第 8 段

Whether this research translates elsewhere is anybody's guess. Ferraro suggests the results may transfer to other parts of Asia, due to commonalities such as the importance of growing rice and market access. And regardless of transferability, the study shows that what's good for people may also be good for the environment. Even if this program didn't reduce poverty, Ferraro says, "the value of the avoided deforestation just for carbon dioxide emissions alone is more than the program costs."

直译：这项研究是否适用于其他地方，谁也说不准。费拉罗认为，由于种植稻米的重要性、市场可达性等共同特点，研究结果可能适用于亚洲其他地区。而且，无论结果是否可以迁移，该研究都表明，对人有益的事，也可能对环境有益。费拉罗说，即使这项计划没有减少贫困，"仅仅从二氧化碳排放角度看，避免森林砍伐所产生的价值，就已经超过了项目成本。"

Text 3

第 1 段

As a historian who's always searching for the text or the image that makes us re-evaluate the past, I've become preoccupied with looking for photographs that show our Victorian ancestors smiling (what better way to shatter the image of 19th-century prudery?). I've found quite a few, and—since I started posting them on Twitter—they have been causing quite a stir. People have been surprised to see evidence that Victorians had fun and could, and did, laugh. They are noting that the Victorians suddenly seem to become more human as the hundred-or-so years that separate us fade away through our common experience of laughter.

直译：作为一名总是在寻找能让我们重新评价过去的文字或图像的历史学家，我越来越专注于寻找那些展现维多利亚时代祖先微笑的照片：还有什么办法，比这更能打破十九世纪拘谨刻板的形象呢？我已经找到相当多张，而且自从我开始把它们发到推特上，它们就引起了不小的轰动。人们惊讶地看到证据，证明维多利亚时代的人也会享乐，能够笑，而且确实笑过。他们注意到，借助我们共有的欢笑体验，那把彼此隔开的一百来年仿佛消失了，维多利亚时代的人突然显得更有人情味。

第 2 段

Of course, I need to concede that my collection of 'Smiling Victorians' makes up only a tiny percentage of the vast catalogue of photographic portraiture created between 1840 and 1900, the majority of which show sitters posing miserably and stiffly in front of painted backdrops, or staring absently into the middle distance. How do we explain this trend?

直译：当然，我需要承认，我收藏的“微笑的维多利亚人”，只占一八四〇年至一九〇〇年间制作的大量肖像照片中极小的一部分。那些照片中的大多数，展现的是被摄者神情凄苦、姿态僵硬地坐在绘制的背景前，或心不在焉地凝望中距离处。我们如何解释这种趋势？

第 3 段

During the 1840s and 1850s, in the early days of photography, exposure times were notoriously long: the daguerreotype photographic method (producing an image on a silvered copper plate) could take several minutes to complete, resulting in blurred images as sitters shifted position or adjusted their limbs. The thought of holding a fixed grin as the camera performed its magical duties was too much to contemplate, and so a non-committal blank stare became the norm.

直译：在十九世纪四五十年代，也就是摄影的早期，曝光时间长得出了名：达盖尔摄影法，即在镀银铜板上形成图像的方法，可能要几分钟才能完成；被摄者移动位置或调整四肢，就会造成图像模糊。想到在相机施展其神奇本领的整个过程中，都得保持固定的咧嘴笑容，人们就觉得难以忍受，因此，不表露态度的茫然凝视成了常态。

第 4 段

But exposure times were much quicker by the 1880s, and the introduction of the Box Brownie and other portable cameras meant that, though slow by today's digital standards, the exposure was almost instantaneous. Spontaneous smiles were relatively easy to capture by the 1890s, so we must look elsewhere for an explanation of why Victorians still hesitated to smile.

直译：但是，到十九世纪八十年代，曝光已经快了许多；布朗尼盒式相机及其他便携相机的出现，意味着曝光虽然按今天的数字技术标准看仍然较慢，但已经几乎可以瞬间完成。到十九世纪九十年代，自发的微笑已经相对容易捕捉，因此，我们必须从别处寻找解释，说明维多利亚时代的人为何仍不愿微笑。

第 5 段

One explanation might be the loss of dignity displayed through a cheesy grin. "Nature gave us lips to conceal our teeth," ran one popular Victorian maxim, alluding to the fact that before the birth of proper dentistry, mouths were often in a shocking state of hygiene. A flashing set of healthy and clean, regular ' pearly whites' was a rare sight in Victorian society, the preserve of the super-rich (and even then, dental hygiene was not guaranteed). A toothy grin (especially when there were gaps or blackened gnashers) lacked class: drunks, tramps, and music hall performers might gurn and grin with a smile as wide as Lewis Carroll's gum-exposing Cheshire Cat, but it was not a becoming look for properly bred persons. Even Mark Twain, a man who enjoyed a hearty laugh, said that when it came to photographic portraits there could be "nothing more damning than a silly, foolish smile fixed forever".

直译：一种解释可能是，咧嘴傻笑会显得失去尊严。维多利亚时代流行的一句格言说："大自然赋予我们嘴唇，是为了遮住牙齿。"这暗指一个事实：在正规牙科学诞生之前，口腔卫生状况往往糟糕得惊人。在维多利亚社会，露出一口健康、洁净、整齐、"珍珠般洁白"的牙齿，是罕见的景象，只有超级富人才可能拥有，而且即使如此，牙齿卫生也没有保障。露齿大笑，尤其是露出缺口或发黑的牙齿，显得不够体面：醉汉、流浪汉和歌舞厅演员可以扮鬼脸、咧嘴笑，像刘易斯·卡罗尔笔下露着牙龈的柴郡猫那样笑得很开，但对教养良好的人来说，这并不是得体的样子。即使是喜欢开怀大笑的马克·吐温也说过，谈到肖像照片，没有什么比"一个永远定格下来的傻乎乎、愚蠢的笑容"更糟糕。

Text 4

第 1 段

From the early days of broadband, advocates for consumers and web-based companies worried that the cable and phone companies selling broadband connections had the power and incentive to favor affiliated websites over their rivals'. That's why there has been such a strong demand for rules that would prevent broadband providers from picking winners and losers online, preserving the freedom and innovation that have been the lifeblood of the Internet.

直译：从宽带发展的早期起，消费者和网络公司的权益倡导者就担心，出售宽带连接的有线电视公司和电话公司，既有能力也有动机偏袒关联网站，而排斥竞争对手的网站。因此，人们一直强烈要求制定规则，防止宽带服务商决定网络上的赢家和输家，以维护互联网赖以生存的自由与创新。

第 2 段

Yet that demand has been almost impossible to fill—in part because of pushback from broadband providers, anti-regulatory conservatives and the courts. A federal appeals court weighed in again Tuesday, but instead of providing a badly needed resolution, it only prolonged the fight. At issue before the U.S. Court of Appeals for the District of Columbia Circuit was the latest take of the Federal Communications Commission (FCC) on net neutrality, adopted on a party-line vote in 2017. The Republican-penned order not only eliminated the strict net neutrality rules the FCC had adopted when it had a Democratic majority in 2015, but rejected the commission's authority to require broadband providers to do much of anything. The order also declared that state and local governments couldn't regulate broadband providers either.

直译：然而，这一要求几乎始终无法得到满足，部分原因是宽带服务商、反监管的保守派及法院的阻力。一家联邦上诉法院星期二再次介入，但它没有提供迫切需要的解决方案，反而只是延长了争斗。提交给美国哥伦比亚特区巡回上诉法院的争议，是联邦通信委员会（FCC）于二〇一七年按党派立场投票通过的最新网络中立政策。这项由共和党人起草的命令，不仅取消了 FCC 在民主党占多数时于二〇一五年通过的严格网络中立规则，还否认该委员会有权要求宽带服务商采取几乎任何行动。该命令还宣布，州及地方政府同样不得监管宽带服务商。

第 3 段

The commission argued that other agencies would protect against anti-competitive behavior, such as a broadband-providing conglomerate like AT&T favoring its own video-streaming service at the expense of Netflix and Apple TV. Yet the FCC also ended the investigations of broadband providers that imposed data caps on their rivals' streaming services but not their own.

直译：该委员会辩称，其他机构将防范反竞争行为，例如 AT&T 这样的宽带综合企业，可能牺牲 Netflix 和 Apple TV 的利益，偏袒自己的视频流媒体服务。然而，FCC 同时也终止了对一些宽带服务商的调查，这些服务商给竞争对手的流媒体服务设置流量上限，却不给自己的服务设置上限。

第 4 段

On Tuesday, the appeals court unanimously upheld the 2017 order deregulating broadband providers, citing a Supreme Court ruling from 2005 that upheld a similarly deregulatory move. But Judge Patricia Millett rightly argued in a concurring opinion that "the result is unhinged from the realities of modern broadband service," and said Congress or the Supreme Court could intervene to "avoid trapping Internet regulation in technological anachronism."

直译：星期二，上诉法院一致维持了二〇一七年放松宽带服务商监管的命令，援引的是最高法院二〇〇五年支持一项类似放松监管举措的裁决。但帕特里夏·米利特法官在一份同意判决结果的意见中正确指出，"这一结果脱离了现代宽带服务的现实"，并表示，国会或最高法院可以介入，以"避免把互联网监管困在过时的技术框架中"。

第 5 段

In the meantime, the court threw out the FCC's attempt to block all state rules on net neutrality, while preserving the commission's power to preempt individual state laws that undermine its order. That means more battles like the one now going on between the Justice Department and California, which enacted a tough net neutrality law in the wake of the FCC's abdication. The endless legal battles and back-and-forth at the FCC cry out for Congress to act. It needs to give the commission explicit authority once and for all to bar broadband providers from meddling in the traffic on their network and to create clear rules protecting openness and innovation online.

直译：与此同时，法院否决了 FCC 试图阻止所有州级网络中立规则的做法，同时保留该委员会排除个别破坏其命令的州法的权力。这意味着，将会有更多类似如今司法部与加州之间的争斗。FCC 放弃监管职责后，加州制定了一部严格的网络中立法。无休止的法律争端，以及 FCC 的反复摇摆，迫切要求国会采取行动。国会需要一劳永逸地明确授予该委员会权力，禁止宽带服务商干预其网络上的流量，并制定清晰规则，保护网络开放与创新。